EMBODIED MUSIC PEDAGOGY

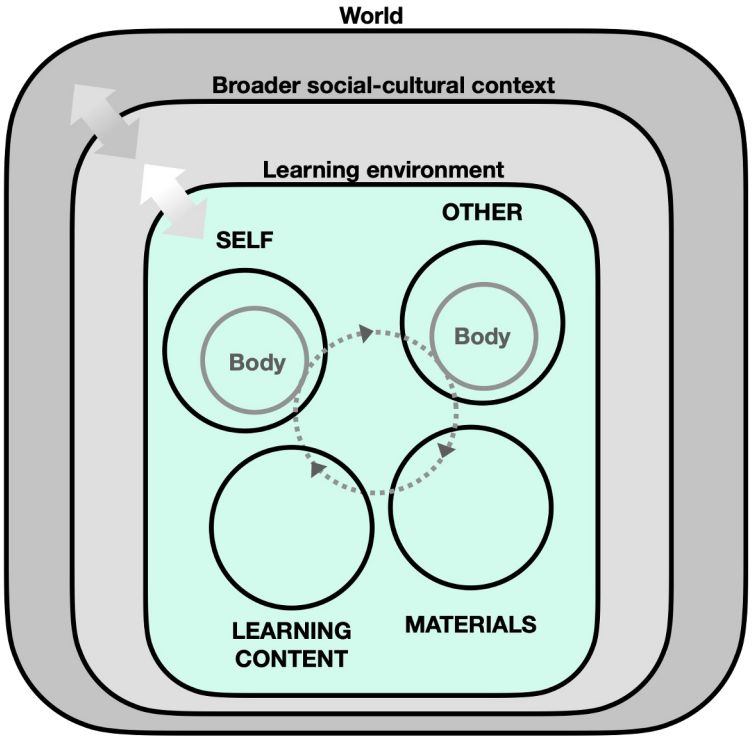
Workshop

MELISSA BREMMER

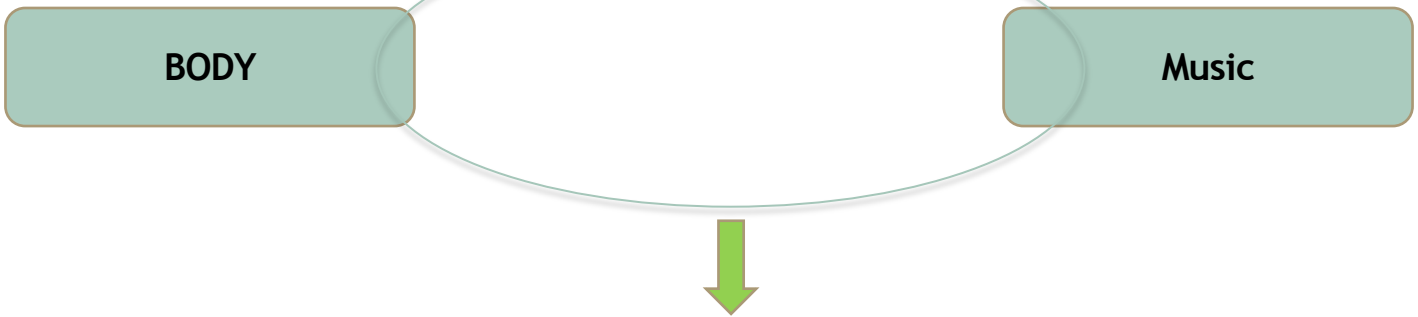
LUC NIJS

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EMBODIED MUSIC PEDAGOGY



EMBODIED INTERACTION WITH MUSIC



Basic mechanisms: Entrainment, Alignment & Prediction

Leman, M. (2016). *The Expressive Moment: How Interaction (with Music) Shapes Human Empowerment*. MIT Press.

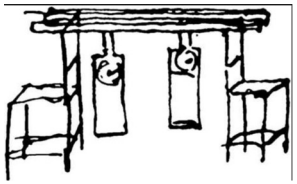
BASIC MECHANISM: ENTRAINMENT

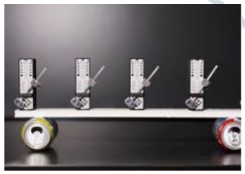
Experience 1:

Walk around freely and try to find a common pulse

BASIC MECHANISM: ENTRAINMENT

Concept of entrainment: ‘the coordination of temporally structured events through interaction’ (Clayton et al, 2004)

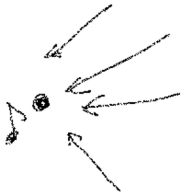




Clocks, people walking, heartbeats…

i.e. through interaction with the group, you are pulled towards a certain beat

You can feel how you’re pulled towards a certain beat or to others.
Develop a sense of a time framework.





Why is entrainment important ?

REFLECTION ON ENTRAINMENT

Training the mechanism of entrainment allows for:

- development of a personal timing framework (what does a pulse/tempo/metre feel like?)

- precision and flexibility in timing between people, needed in (pop, classical, jazz, world music) ensembles/quartet/duo's e.g. without a conductor

- We need entrainment e.g. during improvisation, to keep a common beat going

BASIC MECHANISM: ALIGNMENT

Experience two:

1. Listen to the music of Jimmy Cliff
2. Move to the music in anyway you like

BASIC MECHANISM: ALIGNMENT

Reflection:

To which aspects of the music did you mainly move?

BASIC MECHANISM: ALIGNMENT

As soon as the music begins, people start physically aligning their movements to certain aspects of the music. Two common types of alignment (Leman, 2016):

1. **Phase alignment**: movements matching the beat of music, e.g. stepping or moving the head to the beat

1. **Inter-phase alignment**: the continuous expressive flow of physical actions that matches the time in between the beats of the music.

Physical manifestation of entrainment

BASIC MECHANISM: ALIGNMENT

Experience three: consciously experience phase alignment and inter-phase alignment

1. Form a duo
2. Listen to the same music again
3. One person claps the beats to the music in the air, while the other moves expressively and only claps on the other person's hands on the first beat of every bar.
4. Signal: switch roles

REFLECTION: ALIGNMENT

What is the value of having children move expressively in between the beats, and not only **to** the beat?

REFLECTION: ALIGNMENT

Phase alignment:

- helps to *physically* express one's understanding of the global timing framework of the music
- *discrete* movements help child understand the global timing framework of the music

Inter-phase alignment:

- helps children to *physically* express one's understanding of the music (atmosphere of music, musical dynamics, contour of melodies, tension and release)
- *continuous* expressive movements help child understand music as a flow of organized sounds

BASIC MECHANISM: PREDICTION

1. Walk in sync with the pulse of the Javanese gamelan music, performed by Widosari

REFLECTION: PREDICTION

Prediction is related to the bodily experience: movements provide a physical sensation of recurring patterns, helping to anticipate what comes next.

Such bodily experience are influenced by culturally defined music repertoire.

Physically engaging with different types of music helps developing this basic mechanism, by promoting flexibility and adaptivity

ASSIGNMENT

1. Form pairs
2. Choose one of the basic mechanism
3. Design one or more (instrumental) music activities for your student(s), based on the chosen basic mechanism
4. Describe the activity, using the following online document:

go to: https://bit.ly/isme_EMP or scan the code:

5. Present your activity

MORE INFO?

More practical ideas and theoretical background?
See: www.embodiedmusicpedagogy.org